Poison the river today, bury our future away

"Poison the river today, bury our future away" can be described as a very clear warning regarding water pollution and its impact on humanity. If factories, mining plants, and homes continue pouring contaminated water into the rivers, people will lose their sources of drinking water, crops, and food. For example, in the city of Davao, hundreds of thousands of residents depend on the water of the Davao River and its branches – when they become poisonous, the entire community will have no clean water source.

In addition, the use of the verb "to bury" has two layers of meanings: it can refer both to poisoning the water and destroying everything that relies on its cleanliness. People who die due to water pollution represent those who have no chances to build a better future for themselves and the upcoming generations. Fish disappear, farmers are unable to water their crops, people get sick, and families do not have enough money because of losing income opportunities. This slogan warns that pollution leads to the extinction not only of fish but of humans.

In Davao, water pollution is not some abstract concept – this is an issue that affects each person, and every day people ignore it. The Davao River used to be full of life but now it is increasingly poisoned by chemical elements from upstream mining companies, agriculture, and households. Indigenous and poor people living nearby are suffering the most as a result. That is why the choice of this topic means taking responsibility and trying to protect the rivers of Davao from pollution.